

Hazrat Idrees

Nabi Idrees  is only mentioned twice in the Qur'ān, once in *Surah Maryam* and once in *Surah Ambiya*.

"And remember Idrees in the Book. Verily He was a true Nabi and we raise him to high rank."

(19:56)

"And Ismail and Idrees (*Alaihimus Salām*) and *Zul-kifl* each of them was a greatly patient one."

Name and Offspring

As regards the name, family lineage and era of Nabi Idrees , the Historians are greatly divided and after and after keeping all the different versions in front of us, we are unable to come to a verdict or to a view favoured by most. This is so because the Qur'ān in view of its purpose of providing guidance for mankind, has omitted discussion on historical aspects and only focussed on his Prophet hood, his high rank and his high qualities. In similar fashion hadith reports do not go further than the Qur'ān. For this reason whatever details we have are mostly Israeli reports, which because of their contradictory nature we put aside for the sake

of brevity. The opinion of one group of scholars is that Idrees ؑ was born in the town of Babilon and that he grew up there and in the first part of his life he acquired knowledge from Nabi Sheeth bin Adam ؑ when he reached the age of wisdom Allah endowed him with the office of Prophet hood.

He then started to spread the message of truth among the evil doers of his time. These evil doers did not need his call and opposed the Shariat of Nabi Idrees ؑ and Nabi Sheeth ؑ. Only a small group of people accepted the message of Islām.

When Nabi Idrees ؑ saw this, he decided to perform *Hijrat* from there and advised his followers also to migrate from there. The followers found it very hard to leave their home town, saying: "where will we find a home town like Babilon?"

Nabi Idrees ؑ said to them by way of consolation: "If you are prepared to withstand difficulty in Allah's path, then you will find His Mercy is very wide. He will surely grant you a good exchange. Do not lose courage, and obey His commands."

After they had agreed to migrate Nabi Idrees ؑ and his followers performed *Hijrat* in the direction of Egypt and along a part of the Nile river they chose for themselves a place of residence. There he continued to spread the Message from Allah and invite towards the good while forbidding the evil. It is said that during his time an eloquent form of language was being spoken and also that through Allah's gift to him he was able to speak in most languages on earth. He used to convey the message to each nation in their own language. According to another report Nabi Idrees ؑ was the first person to make use of the pen.

The Special Qualities

Apart from conveying the message of the Religion of Allah, Nabi Idrees عليه السلام also taught people the civilized manner of running their civil affairs in the towns and villages and his disciples have for almost two centuries there after been responsible for inhabiting the towns. He also taught his disciples other forms of knowledge, for example philosophy and astronomy. It is said he is the first person to teach philosophy and astronomy as Allah had given him the knowledge of the heavenly bodies and their movements, the stars, their coming together and their separation together with their magnetic pull. Allah also made him a scholar of numeral and mathematics and if these arts had no been discovered by him, mankind would have had great difficulty in having acquired that knowledge.

He is also responsible for having promulgated various laws for various groups of people in society according to their various situations and divided the earth into four sections and for every one of the four sections appointed a ruler who had to rule over that section on condition that the Divine law brought by him would be uppermost in the legal system.

Synopsis of His Teachings

First of all he taught that everyone should believe in *Touheed*-the one-ness of Allah, and only He as the creator of the universe should be worshipped. One should busy himself with righteous deeds in this world in order to be saved in the hereafter. One should be disconnected from this world. In all matters and affairs justice should prevail. One should busy himself with the worship of Allah in the prescribed manner and should fast during the three middle

days of the lunar months. It is also required that *Jihad* be made against the enemies of Islām, that *Zakah* should be given to the needy. Special care should be taken towards *Tahaarat* and cleanliness, and to avoid dogs and swine, as well as all intoxicants.

Future Prophets

He also informed his people that like him many other Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) would appear in future for the worldly and spiritual guidance of mankind and that their outstanding features will be as follows:

They will be completely free of all evil. They will be praise worthy men of high virtues. They will have full knowledge of this world and the heavens, and will be aware of all the remedies for any part of this universe or all illnesses, which knowledge will come to them through Divine Inspiration and Revelation.

They will also be men whose prayers will be answered by Allah. The summary of their message will be the reform and rectification of this world.

The Khilafat of Nabi Idrees

When Nabi Idrees  was made the ruler of this earth, he divided the inhabitants in three classes according to their knowledge and actions. These three classes were (a) the Priests (b) The Kings (c) The Subjects. Their ranks were fixed in this sequence. The priests were the highest in rank and they were only responsible to Allah in the affairs of the kings and the subjects. The next in rank were the kings who were responsible for the affairs of the state. The subjects were only responsible for their own selves and were therefore in the third rank. These ranks were fixed according to their compulsory

duties and obligations and were not according to their family connections or tribal considerations.

Nabi Idrees عليه السلام used to continue to have these laws carried out diligently until the time came for his being "raised up to Allah."

The Few Special Points

Nabi Idrees عليه السلام had a ring on which was inscribed the following phrase: "Together with the faith in Allah, patience is the cause of success and victory. "On the griddle which he wore around his body was written: "The true festival days are hidden in the carrying out of the commands of Allah. The perfection of *Deen* is connected with the *Shariat*. Kindness is the highest step for the perfection of the *Deen*."

At the time of funeral, the girdle worn around the waste of a person had this sentence inscribed on it: "The fortunate person is he who protects his self and the intercession for a man before Allah is his good deeds."

The Advices of Nabi Idrees عليه السلام

Many of the advices and sayings of Nabi Idrees عليه السلام are well known. Many of these are used like proverbs in various languages. Here are some of them.

1. To express adequate thanks for Allah's numerous bounties and favours is beyond man's capability.
2. Whosoever desires to reach perfection in knowledge and desires to be a door of righteousness, should never go near to the causes of ignorance and bad character. Don't you see that when a skilled artist wishes to sew something he takes a needle in his hand and not a drill. Thus one should at all times keep this principle in mind.

3. Showing kindness to someone in this world can lead to sorrow and to be boastful of Allah leads to regret.
4. For the remembrance of Allah and for the performance of righteous deeds a precondition is sincerity.
5. Do not take false oaths. And do not use the Name of Allah for taking oaths and do not force liars to swear and take oaths, because by so doing you become a partner in his wrong deed and the sin thereof.
6. Do not adopt a lowly profession as for example as for example receiving payment for allowing animals to copulate; fertilize and impregnate other animals.
7. Obey the kings, who have been appointed over you by the Prophets for the implementation of Allah's laws, remain humble in the presence of your elders and at all times keep your tongue wet with the praises of Allah.
8. Wisdom is the life of the Soul.
9. Do not be jealous over the good life others enjoy because this happy life only lasts a few days.
10. Whosoever seeks more than the necessities of life will never become satisfied and contented.

Some research scholars and biographers have tried to prove some similarity between Nabi Idrees  and Hermes, the Greek mythological figure. But this is wrong. Hermes is a figure of mythology who is noted for some wise sayings; whereas Idrees  was a Prophet of Allah.

QASASUL AMBIYAA

STORIES OF THE PROPHETS

Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy (Rah.)



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Qasasul Ambiyaa

(Stories of the Prophets)

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Qasasul Ambiyaa

The Holy Qur'ān does not relate historical facts merely for the sake of telling a story which is of historical value. Its main aim in relating happenings is to draw attention to the results, conclusions and deductions from these incidents so that they become a source of guidance for men and prove to be lessons for them that appeal to their minds and emotions that from these historical events, lessons should be derived. These lessons should convince them that the existence of Allah is an undeniable fact and that His Mighty Hand is playing a major role in the affairs of men. It should also bring to their notice that to follow the stipulations of His deen brings success and leads to salvation and is the way towards all progress. That is what Islām—the natural religion—is about.

From: Qasasul Qur'ān

Preface

The most authentic and comprehensive work of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy, *Qasasul Qur'ān* needs no introduction. However, the Manner in which our friend Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version of a voluminous and bulky work he has undoubtedly, fulfilled one of the needs of this time. He has adopted such a method of abridgement whereby not only has he retained and mentioned every important fact in the lives of the Holy Prophets (*Alaihimus Salām*) and other saintly personalities, which are of lessons to men, but also discussed in brought outline some other important matters. It is hoped that with Allah's grace, those persons who are occupied and busy at all times, will be able to derive adequate benefit from this work.

The great effort of Sayed Tanzeem Hussain in this old age of his is really something praiseworthy. May Allah reward him well for this great effort.

Qari Sayed Rasheedul-Hasan Hussainy Nadwi

Imam and Khateeb

Jama Masjid, New Town

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P5 Muharram, 1308 Hijri

Publisher's Foreword

The respected personality of Maulana Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy is one of the most eminent Ulama of the Indo-Pak Sub-Continent. His most approved and well-known book, *Qasasul-Qur'ān* is considered to be a unique publication on this subject. The point that distinguishes it from other similar books is the fact that after every story, Maulana has made use of deep thought and reflection to present to the readers the lessons and points of guidance from the related episodes. Thus for the teachers and lecturers at *Deeni Madressas* and for preachers in mosques and students of deen the study and perusal of this book is of utmost benefit.

The original book appeared in four volumes with over 1800 pages of subject matter. Sayed Tanzeem Hussain Saheb has brought forth an abridged version there of in only 600 pages and this has been met with a verdict of approval from all academic circles, especially by virtue of the fact that he has fulfilled one of the most pressing needs of the time and by leaving aside unimportant discussions have given the busy and occupied ones also a chance to benefit from these work. May Allah reward him well.

Author's Foreword

All praise be to Allah who has guided us with the Holy Book and revealed to us the Qur'ān in a clear Arabic language and in it. He related the best of stories as an admonition and a reminder for the believers. And May peace and blessings be upon the Most truthful and trustworthy Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, the messenger of Allah and seal of all the Prophets and upon his offspring, and companions who were all of them guiding stars for all the righteous ones.

Among the inimitable ways in which Allah has chosen for the sake of the guidance of men, is this that attention is drawn to the good and bad deeds of nations and the resultant fruits of such deeds of which they are reminded so that those deeds may be a lesson for men. For this reason those stories are not being related in a style as is generally done in history. The major aim is to convey the truth and to invite to Allah and with this in mind attention is only drawn to those aspects which furthers this objective. For this reason there is constant repetition so that these events can sink into the hearts and minds of listeners and they become attentive towards them. This sinking in and attentiveness can only be achieved if the same event is repeated in various ways and styles whereby sleeping faculties are woken up.

The Qur'ānic stories and events deal mostly with previous nations and the Messengers of Allah (*Alaihimus*

Salām) who were sent to them and bit by bit other matters also become included there-in, mostly dealing with the arguments over good and bad and the battles between the friends of Allah and the friends of *Shaitan*, which in itself proves to be a great lesson and admonishment for me.

But, leaving others aside, there are today so few Muslims who derive benefit from Allah's last and perfect law-book, the Qur'ān, to fill our hearts with *Iman* and *Yaqeen*. After all it is Allah's law and we are commanded to implement its orders in our lives, Moreover we are required to ponder over its meanings as this Qur'ān is the means forwards acquiring success and salvation in both this world and the here after.

At the time of the Revelation of the Qur'ān, the Messenger of Allah became so distressed and defected at the enmity and opposition of the polytheists that he raised this complaint to Allah:

(5:25—30)

However, in this 15th century, if we should examine our hearts, we will find that in spite of our claims to be Muslims and believing the Qur'ān to be the word of Allah, how few are who have made this word of Allah the pattern for their lives and the model on which to base their lives, who read and recited with this aim in mind?

It was my aim, seeing this condition of my people and myself, to translate this great source of admonition into Urdu so that by presenting the translated version, the hearts of people will automatically become drawn to the original i.e., the Qur'ān and thereby acquire everlasting happiness.

In spite of my simple style of writing, care has been taken to confine myself to a few special points.

- (a) In this book the basis for all the stories is the Holy Qur'ān and the authentic *Hadith* and these have been further elucidated with historical facts.
- (b) Where there appears any contradiction or differences in the stories as told in the old testament and the Qur'ān, then with clear arguments an effort has been made either to reconcile the versions or with clear arguments to prove the truth as is expounded in the Qur'ān.
- (c) An effort has been made to point out the nonsensical Israili stories and where there have been nonsensical objections from enemies, these have in the light of the true facts been made clear for what they are.
- (d) In some special places there have been introduced some discussions on matters of disputes in *Tafseer* and *Hadith* and after discussing these the views of the saintly elders have been mentioned as a solution.
- (e) The facts concerning every Prophet ﷺ and in which chapter of the Qur'ān they are mentioned, has been gathered in one place.
- (f) Lastly, together with all the above points, a special heading of "Results and lessons", is introduced, giving the actual objective of this book and its main purpose viz., admonition and warning. Special attention is drawn to this aspect.

Servant of the Millat

Muhammad Hifzur Rahman Seoharwy

22 Rajab, 1360 Hijri

Translator's Foreword

For me as the translator of this book by Maulana Hifzur Rahman is a great honour. Throughout my student days in Darul Uloom Deoband in India, Maulana Hifzur Rahman or as we know him then as the *Mujahid-e-Millat* was one of the most respected leaders of the Muslim community. We used to flock to listen to his most interesting lectures. And as the general secretary of the *Jamiatul-Ulama*, and a M.P. he was also a great 'Alim (scholar) as can be gauged from this book *Qasasul Ambiya* (Tales of the Prophets) which entailed great research. I can remember whenever the students were confronted with any problem in the lives of any of the prophets, they always took refuge in Maulana's book for answers. I took upon it as a great honour in being in some small manner associated with Maulana's scholarship, even though this is an abridged version of the original book. But I must also state that I found great difficulty in translating this book because of the exceptionally high quality of the Urdu language used in the book.

I hope that the English translation of Maulana Hifzur Rahman's scholarly work will also be of great benefit to the English-speaking people. I just hope that I have been able to do justice to the original thoughts of the author.

Yusuf Karaan
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